

have created educational modules for developers to learn on their own.

Q. What is the response to Oracle's cloud offerings in the Indian market?

The response has been great. India is a key growth market for us within the APAC region, and we're closely working with customers to help them in their journey to the cloud. There are a lot of Indian customers who are using our cloud and realising significant value. One good example is Bajaj Electricals. The company used Oracle's AI enabled intelligent bot service, and was able to build and pilot an intuitive, consumer-friendly chatbot in just under three weeks. This has enabled the company to reduce its call centre headcount significantly, as a vast number of consumer enquiries are getting addressed via the chatbot.

Q. Can you tell us something about the type of solutions you're offering?

We continue to push the envelope of what's possible. Our complete focus is on creating value for our customers. For example, our SaaS applications have the capability to harness data intelligently to enable a customer service representative to find out the next best offer, a sales representative the next best opportunity and a recruiter the next best candidate to invest in. We are building that kind of intelligence into our SaaS applications by leveraging first party data, third party data and ML models. Our focus is more on how one can get actionable intelligence as opposed to just offering the platform to build a whole bunch of different intelligent pieces. Similarly, we are embedding intelligent services into our management and analytics offerings. That's how we are delivering the intelligence aspect of our platform.

The Oracle Autonomous Database, which is the world's first and only 'self-driving, self-securing and self-repairing' database, is one of the most important and successful new product introductions in our company's 40-year history.

Powered by advanced machine learning, the Oracle Autonomous Database can scale itself, patch itself, manage itself — and it is continuously learning. In addition, you don't have to do indexing. A developer can just focus on building the next killer app, and not get bogged down with database management or any other 'less creative, mundane' tasks.

Codeinks, a Bengaluru based ecommerce software product startup, was looking to extract deep levels of insight into user behaviour and past performance to do better future predictions of trends. Oracle Autonomous Data Warehouse Cloud made a huge difference and the company was able to achieve performance improvements ranging from 30 to 50% on average for its defined scenarios.

“We have just added more intelligence to the Oracle Database and crafted the Oracle Autonomous Database.”

Q. How do you see the adoption of AI and ML technologies on a large scale?

I think there are two things that have made AI and ML more pervasive in recent months. First, the amount of data that's being generated and collected. Second, the easy availability of the heavy duty computing capacity needed to make sense of this data, quickly. GPUs and Flash memories that can run lots of applications in memory are now available. There have been high bandwidth connections between various nodes — whereby nodes can talk to each other. These are some of the developments that have fundamentally made ML and AI possible at scale. I think the place where there is a broader adoption of ML is in the conversational paradigm of AI, where people engage in intelligent conversations through the messaging interface.

Like I mentioned earlier, we're embedding intelligence into each of our cloud services, and at times customers

don't even know or realise this. If we revisit the autonomous database example, we are able to patch the database, scale it, optimise the queries, as well as create or remove the indexes that need it. And that's where the mass adoption of AI happens, because anyone who is building the cloud application and leveraging any of these cloud services can start seeing the value.

Q. You have mentioned the autonomous database. Is this only on the cloud or is an on-premise version also available?

At the moment, the Oracle Autonomous Database is only on the cloud. However, we are working on getting the on-premise version as well, in the coming months.

Q. Is the autonomous database open, or is it available in Oracle's data centres only?

We have just added more intelligence to the Oracle Database and crafted the Oracle Autonomous Database. While it's not open source based, per se, the Oracle Database is one of the most flexible databases out there — it is extremely open in a way that it can run anywhere. If you look at some of our competitors who offer cloud based services, they're tied strictly to their cloud and can't run anywhere else. So, you don't have the portability — the ability to run the Oracle content either in the public cloud or within your data centre or in a third-party cloud.

Q. There is a debate regarding the law that mandates data to reside within the country in which it has been collected. What are your thoughts on that?

We'll abide by all government regulations, not just in India, but in every country/region we operate in. We believe Oracle Cloud at Customer is tailor-made for companies (public or in the corporate sector) looking to enjoy all the benefits of a public cloud environment, but behind their own firewall (inside their own data centre). Further, we've already announced that we'll soon be opening our India data centre later this year; so we're well prepared to address